Country NDCs and the Platform's Featured Countries

> Part of the Functional Series. Each country's Paris commitment is its NDC. This document sets out the NDCs of the platform's ten featured countries, UNEP's assessment of whether current policies reach the 2030 targets, and where the platform's own data sit against them. **The comparisons are indicative**: NDC targets and the platform's series differ in scope, and the differences are large for several countries (§3).

1. What each country has pledged

From UNEP's *Emissions Gap Report 2025*, Table 3.1 (NDCs and announced 2035 pledges as of 30 September 2025). Germany is covered by the European Union's collective NDC.

Country	2030 NDC	2035 NDC or announced pledge
China	Peak CO_2 before 2030; cut CO_2 per unit of GDP 65% from 2005; non-fossil fuels about 25% of primary energy; 1,200 GW wind and solar	Cut net GHG emissions **7–10% from peak levels** by 2035, "striving to do better"; non-fossil share over 30%; wind and solar to 3,600 GW
United States	–50–52% from 2005	–61–66% from 2005 (the NDC is no longer in effect after 27 January 2026, as the US is withdrawing)
India	Cut GHG per unit of GDP 45% from 2005; about 40% non-fossil power capacity (conditional on finance); additional 2.5–3 $GtCO_2e$ carbon sink	No new NDC submitted or announced by 30 September 2025
Russia	GHG up to 70% of the 1990 level	65–67% of the 1990 level
Japan	–46% from 2013	–60% from 2013 (and –73% by 2040)
European Union (Germany)	At least –55% net from 1990	Announced: –66–72% net from 1990
Brazil	–53% net from 2005	–59–67% net from 2005
United Kingdom	At least –68% from 1990	At least –81% from 1990
South Africa	Limit 2030 emissions to 350–420 $MtCO_2e$	No new NDC submitted or announced by 30 September 2025
Australia	–43% from 2005	–62–70% from 2005

Three features of these pledges matter for comparison:

- **Different base years** (1990, 2005, 2013, or "peak") and **different metrics**: absolute reductions, a percentage of a base level, an emission-intensity target (China, India), or a range of emissions (South Africa).
- **Net or gross.** "Net" targets count removals by forests and land, which can be large (Brazil, Australia, Russia, the United States).

- **Unconditional or conditional**: some pledges depend on international finance (India's non-fossil capacity target, South Africa's 2030 range).

2. Are current policies enough to reach the 2030 targets?

UNEP assesses, from several independent modelling studies, whether current policies reach each country's **unconditional 2030** target. The bracket gives the number of studies projecting that it will be met out of those considered.

Country	Assessment	Studies
China	Likely to meet	6 of 7
European Union	Likely to meet (but see below)	2 of 3
India	Likely to meet	4 of 5
Russia	Likely to meet; projected about 25% below its target level	3 of 3
South Africa	Likely to meet its (conditional) range	2 of 4
Japan	Less likely; "very close"	1 of 4
Australia	Less likely; "very close" (its own projection agrees)	1 of 3
Brazil	Less likely	0 of 3
United Kingdom	Less likely (official UK projections also do not expect to meet the target)	0 of 2
United States	Less likely	0 of 2

UNEP counts seven G20 members as likely to meet their 2030 targets and nine as not; the grouping above follows its table and text. Official projections for the EU (the European Environment Agency), the UK and Canada show those governments do **not** expect to meet their point-in-time 2030 targets under current policies, so the EU's "likely" rests on independent studies.

In aggregate: G20 emissions under current policies are projected at about 35 $GtCO_2e$ in 2030 and 33 $GtCO_2e$ in 2035. The *implementation gap* (between the unconditional NDCs and current policies) is about 2 $GtCO_2e$, rising to 3–4 if adjusted for overachievement by some countries.

Two changes since last year are material for the featured countries:

- **China's current-policy projections now show emissions peaking around 2025** and falling by 0.3–1.4 $GtCO_2e$ by 2030, because renewable generation is growing faster than power demand. Earlier projections showed growth to 2030.
- **The United States' 2030 projection rose by about 1 $GtCO_2e$** after policy reversals.

3. Where the platform's data sit

The platform's series are **gross national emissions excluding land use** (PRIMAP-hist total GHG; OWID CO_2), and its BAU path is a statistical continuation of each country's own CO_2 history. NDCs are mostly **net** and **include**

land use, and are measured against different base years. Treat every number below as an indication of direction and distance, not as a target assessment.

Country	NDC base	Observed 2024 vs base (platform GHG)	Platform BAU CO_2 vs base, 2030 / 2035	Reading
China	peak	At a record high (CO_2 12.3 Gt; GHG 15.5 Gt)	CO_2 13.5 Gt (+9.6% on 2024) / 14.4 Gt	**BAU keeps rising; UNEP's policy studies show a peak around 2025.** The platform's trend model cannot see policy-driven change
United States	2005	–17.4%	CO_2 –22.6% / –24.1%	Far from –50–52%; the pledge is withdrawn in any case
India	2005 (intensity)	+109% in absolute terms; at a record high	CO_2 +220% / +262%	Target is intensity, not absolute; not comparable
Russia	1990	–32.5%	CO_2 –27.0% / –25.6%	Already past –30% on a gross basis
Japan	2013	–24.5%	CO_2 –31.2% / –33.2%	Short of –46% (2030) on gross figures; UNEP says "very close" on net
Germany (EU)	1990	–48.0%	CO_2 –51.7% / –56.9%	–51.7% by 2030 on BAU, short of the EU-wide –55% (net); Germany has no separate NDC
Brazil	2005 (net)	+26.9% gross	CO_2 +38.1% / +41.8%	**Not comparable:** Brazil's net target counts land-use emissions and removals that the platform excludes
United Kingdom	1990	–52.0%	CO_2 –55.5% / –59.0%	Short of –68% (2030)
South Africa	absolute range	522 $MtCO_2e$ (2024)	CO_2 flat at about 444 Mt	Above the 350–420 range on a gross basis; scope differs
Australia	2005	–2.2%	CO_2 +2.2% / +2.6%	Far from –43% gross; Australia's net figure, with its land sink, is much lower

Observations:

- **The platform and UNEP disagree about China, for a clear reason.** The platform's BAU is a damped continuation of 1990–2024 CO_2 and does not know that clean-power additions are now outpacing demand growth. This is the clearest example of why the platform's forecasts are "if past trends continue", not predictions.
- **Scope decides the answer.** Where a target is net of land-use removals, comparing it with gross emissions overstates the distance still to go; where land use is a net source (Brazil), the comparison is not meaningful at all.
- **India and China are the two featured countries whose absolute emissions are still at record highs** (platform data). Both pledge intensity or peak-based targets, not absolute cuts from a past base year.
- **Having cut emissions by half since 1990 does not guarantee the next target.** Germany and the UK are each about 48–52% below 1990 on the platform's gross figures, yet UNEP assesses the UK as less likely to meet its 2030 target on current policies.

4. What the new NDCs add up to

- **Only 64 Parties, covering 63% of global emissions, had submitted or announced new NDCs** by UNEP's cut-off of 30 September 2025, against a February 2025 deadline.
- UNEP estimates full implementation of the 2035 NDCs would cut emissions about **12% (unconditional) to 15% (conditional) below 2019** by 2035, or 9% and 11% without the US NDC. The secretariat's update presented at COP30 reportedly put it at about 12% below 2019 across a larger set of NDCs.
- The pathway benchmarks for 2035 are **–35% (2 °C) and –55% (1.5 °C)** in UNEP's pathway set.
- The resulting warming projections span **2.3–2.5 °C** if all NDCs are fully implemented, against up to 2.8 °C under current policies (UNEP), with the Climate Action Tracker at 2.6 °C for both.

Conclusions for the platform follow in the Findings section (in development).

See also

- The Paris Agreement and the COP Process
- The Paris Targets as Numbers
- Pathways, Carbon Budgets and Warming Outlooks
- Forecasting: why the BAU trend is not a forecast of policy